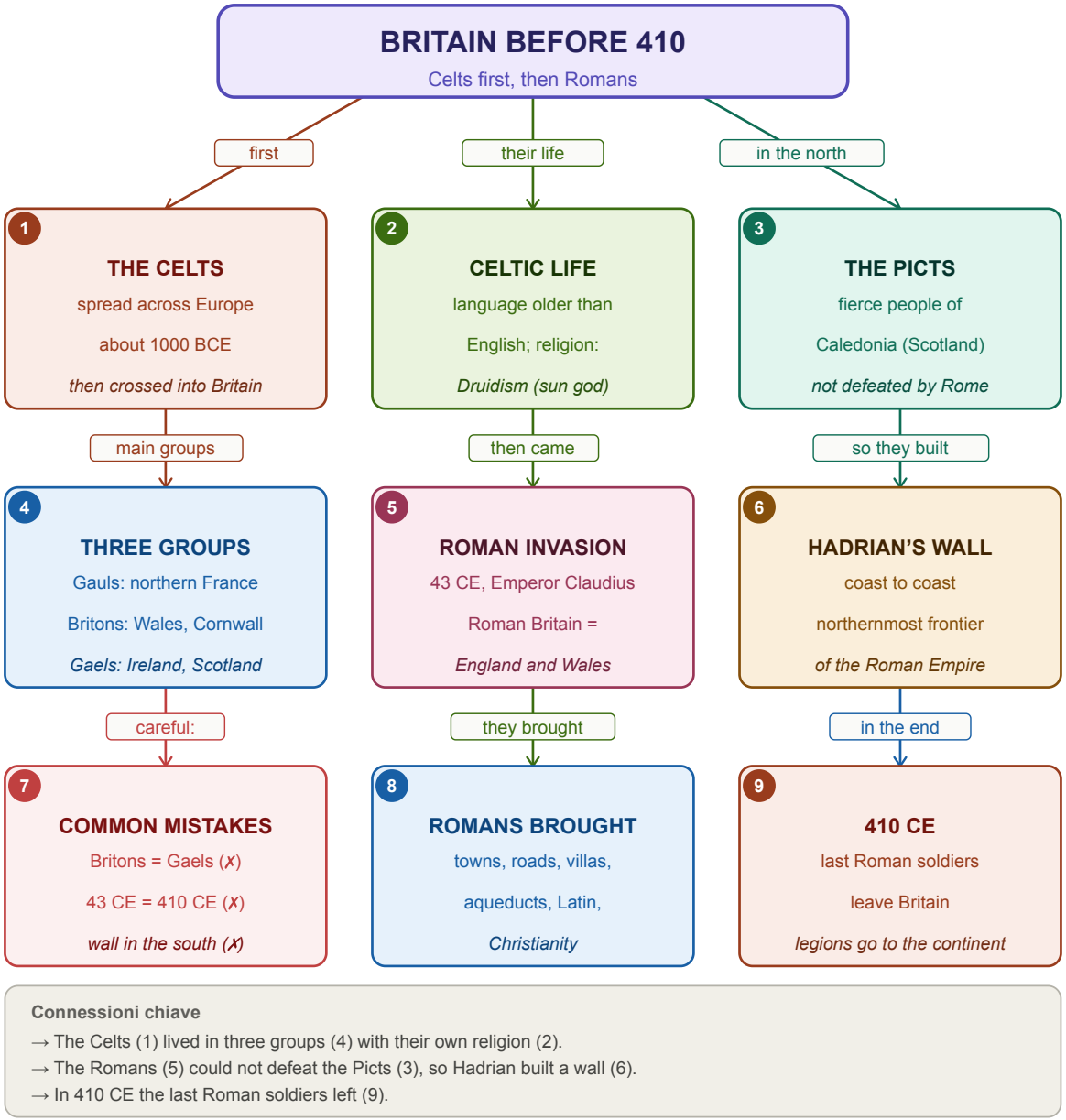
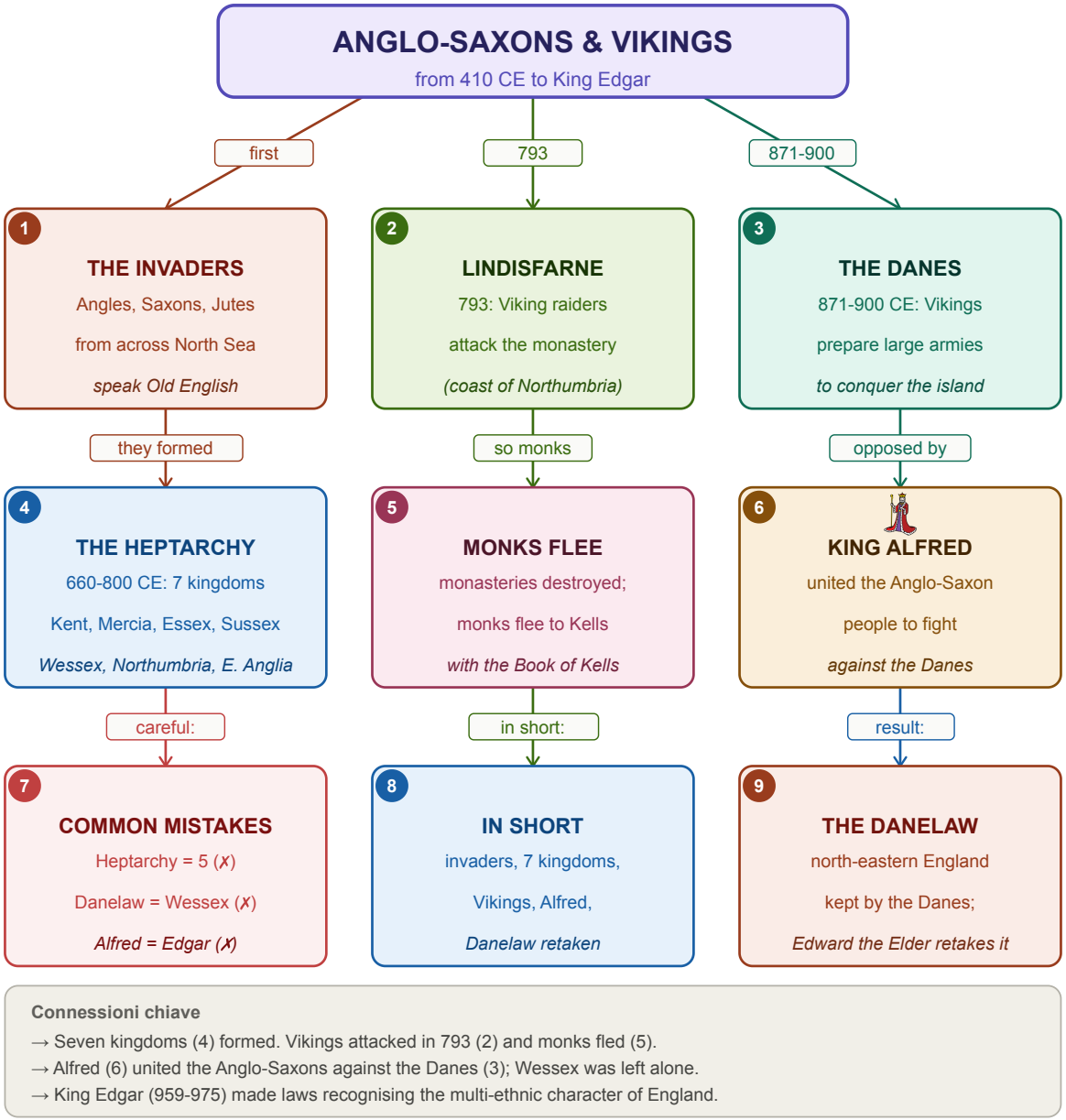
Mappa concettuale · Celts and Romans



Connessioni chiave

→ The Celts (1) lived in three groups (4) with their own religion (2).
→ The Romans (5) could not defeat the Picts (3), so Hadrian built a wall (6).
→ In 410 CE the last Roman soldiers left (9).

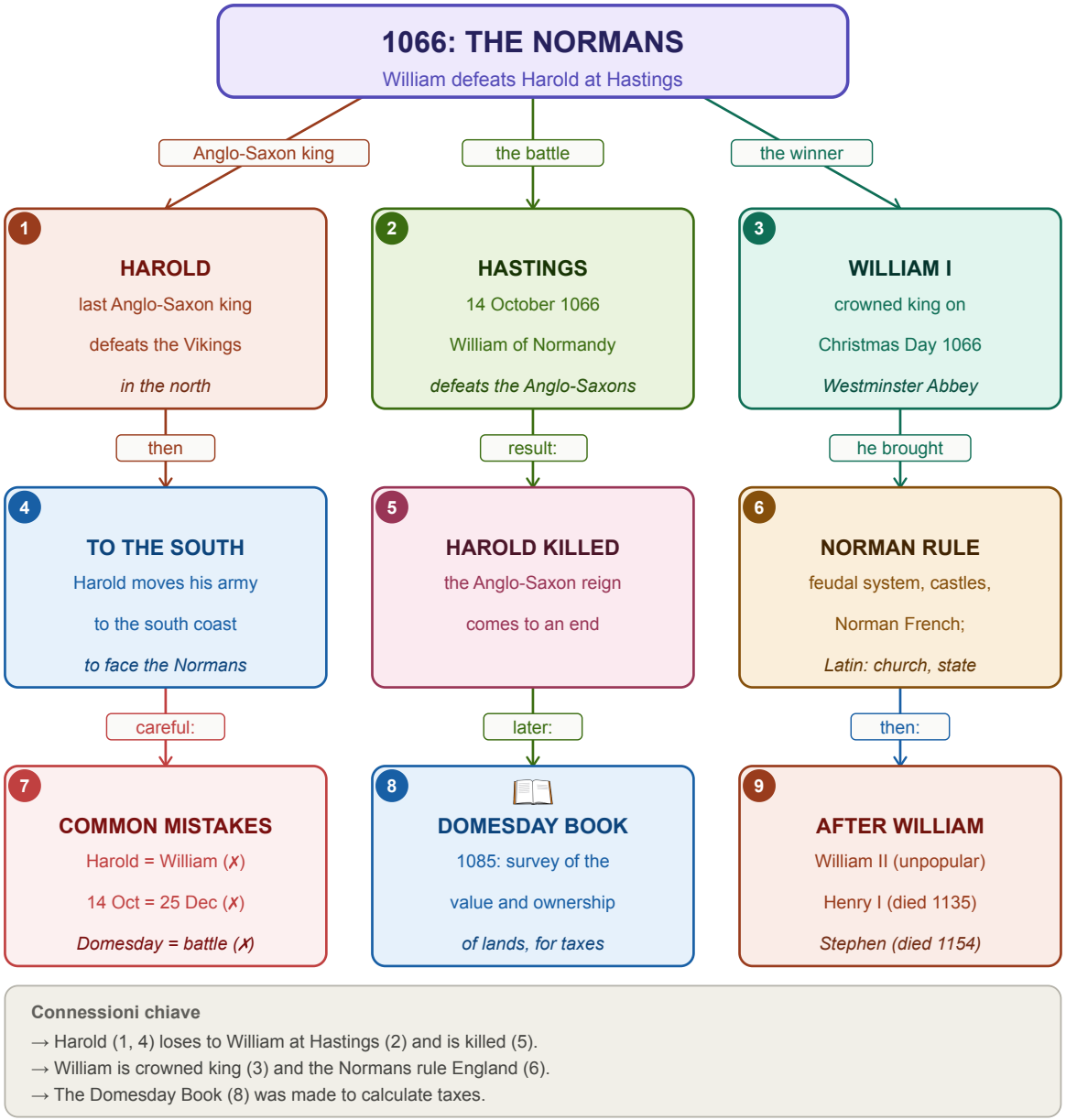
Mappa concettuale · Anglo-Saxons, Vikings



Connessioni chiave

→ Seven kingdoms (4) formed. Vikings attacked in 793 (2) and monks fled (5).
→ Alfred (6) united the Anglo-Saxons against the Danes (3); Wessex was left alone.
→ King Edgar (959-975) made laws recognising the multi-ethnic character of England.

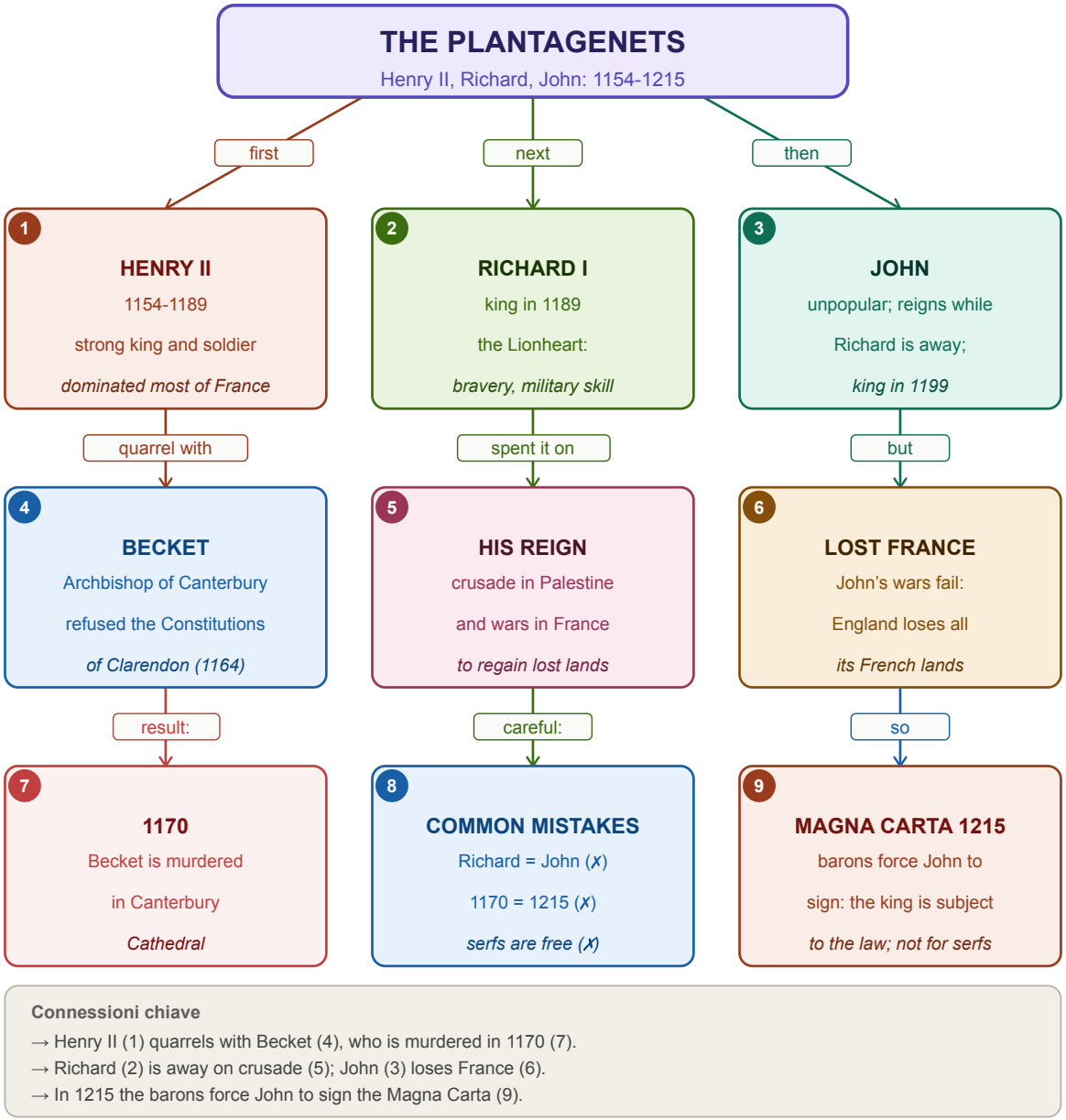
Mappa concettuale · 1066: the Normans



Connessioni chiave

→ Harold (1, 4) loses to William at Hastings (2) and is killed (5).
→ William is crowned king (3) and the Normans rule England (6).
→ The Domesday Book (8) was made to calculate taxes.

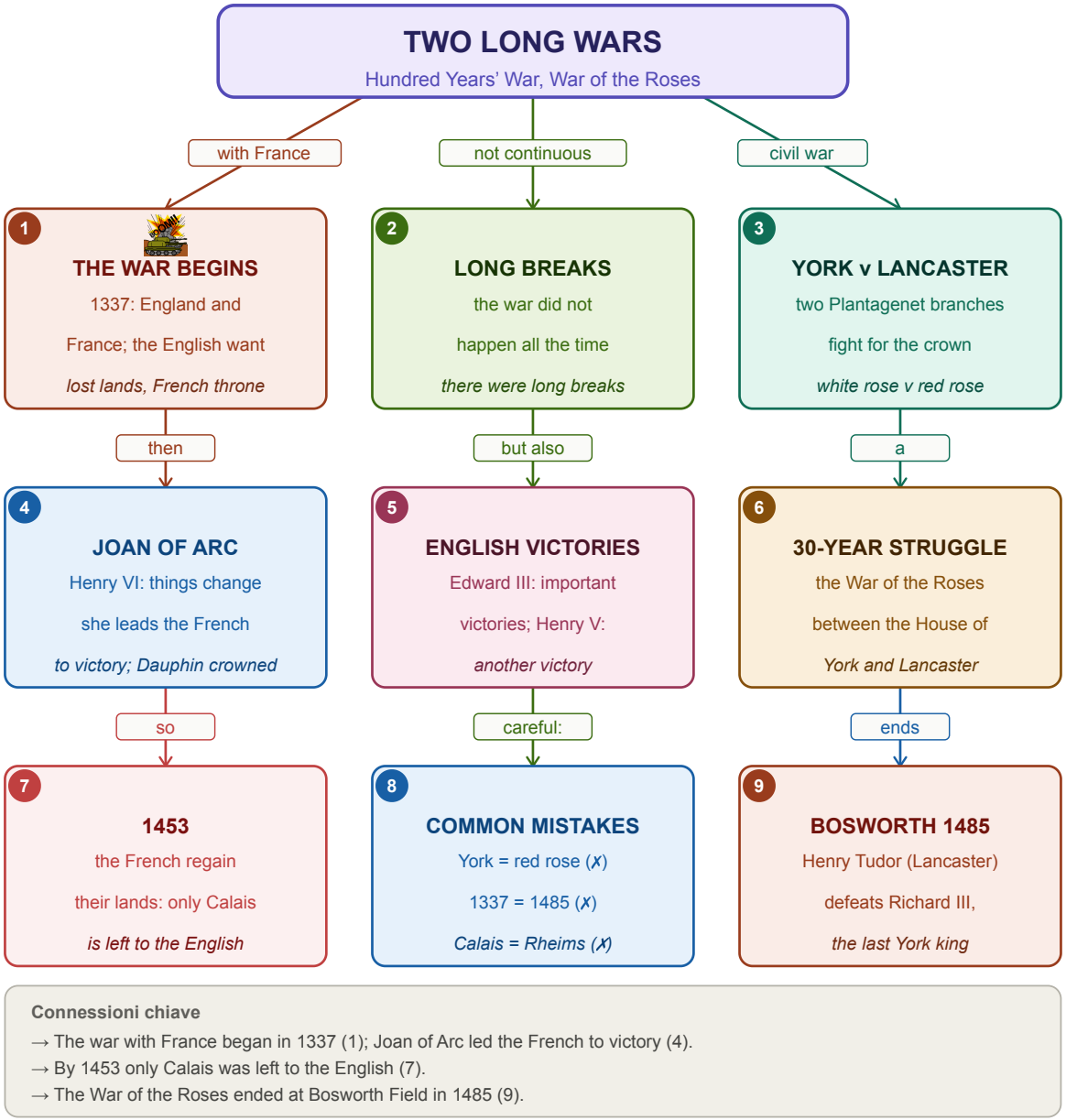
Mappa concettuale · Henry II to Magna Carta



Connessioni chiave

→ Henry II (1) quarrels with Becket (4), who is murdered in 1170 (7).
→ Richard (2) is away on crusade (5); John (3) loses France (6).
→ In 1215 the barons force John to sign the Magna Carta (9).

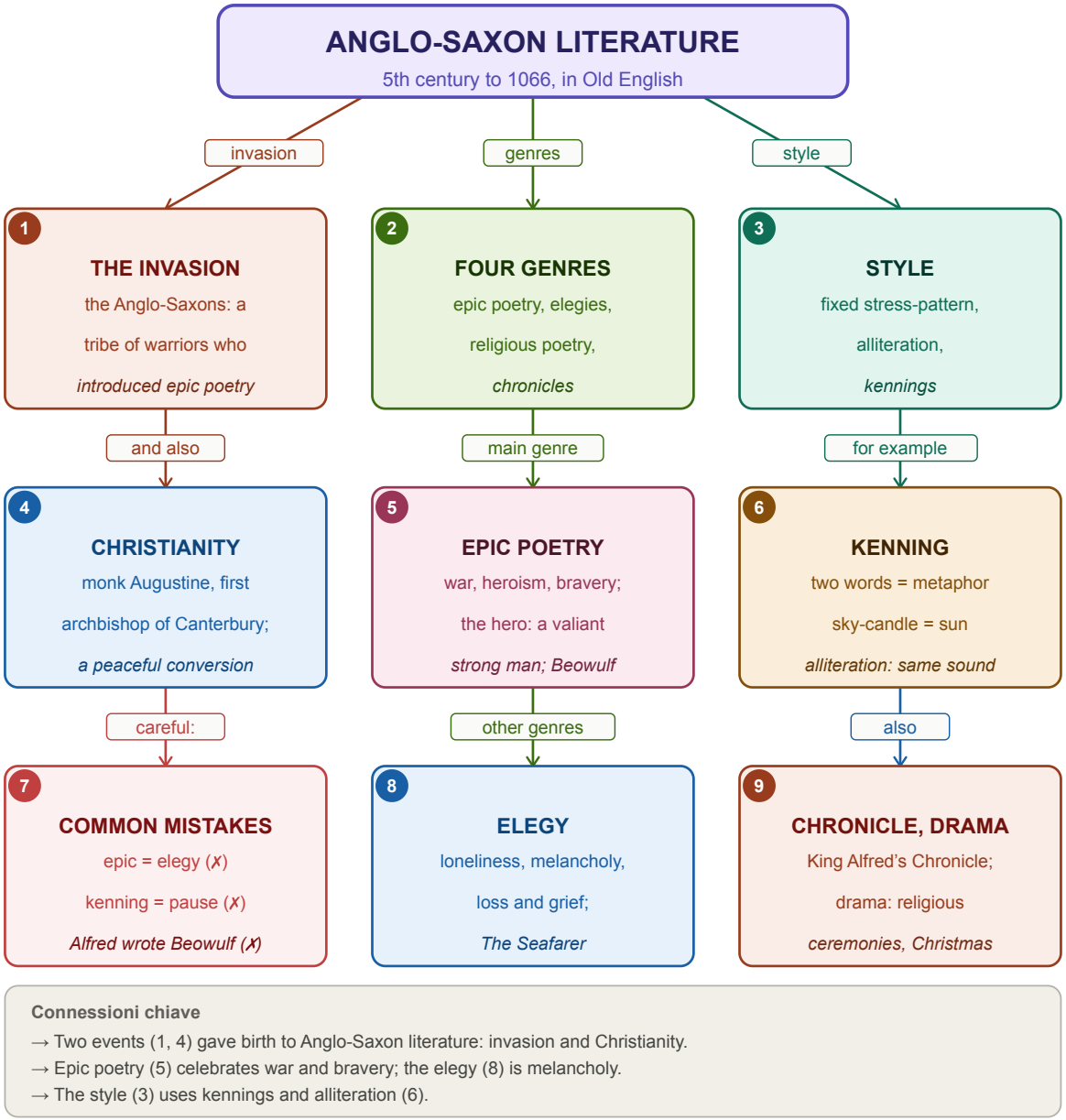
Mappa concettuale · The wars



Connessioni chiave

→ The war with France began in 1337 (1); Joan of Arc led the French to victory (4).
→ By 1453 only Calais was left to the English (7).
→ The War of the Roses ended at Bosworth Field in 1485 (9).

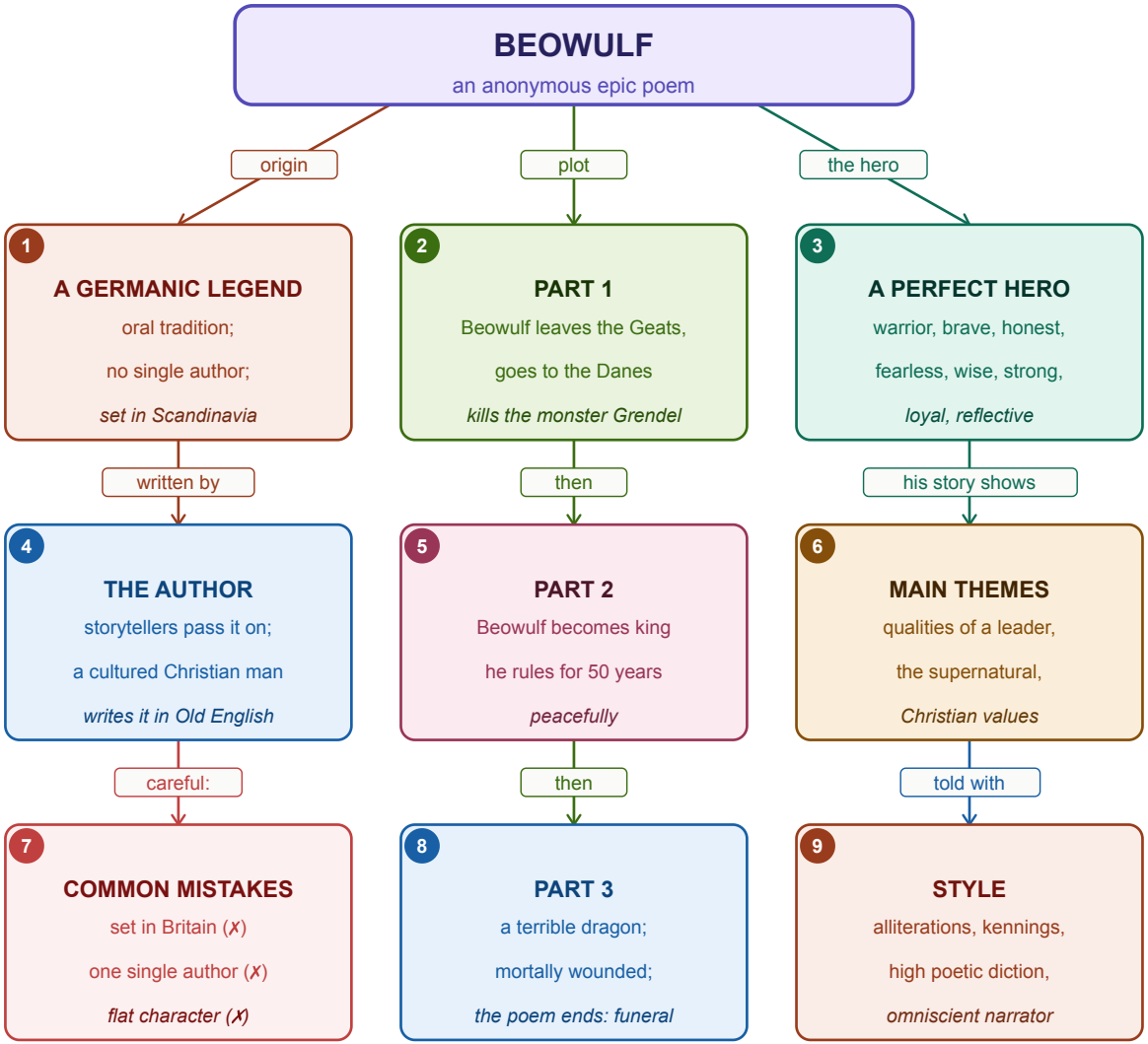
Mappa concettuale · Anglo-Saxon literature



Connessioni chiave

→ Two events (1, 4) gave birth to Anglo-Saxon literature: invasion and Christianity.
→ Epic poetry (5) celebrates war and bravery; the elegy (8) is melancholy.
→ The style (3) uses kennings and alliteration (6).

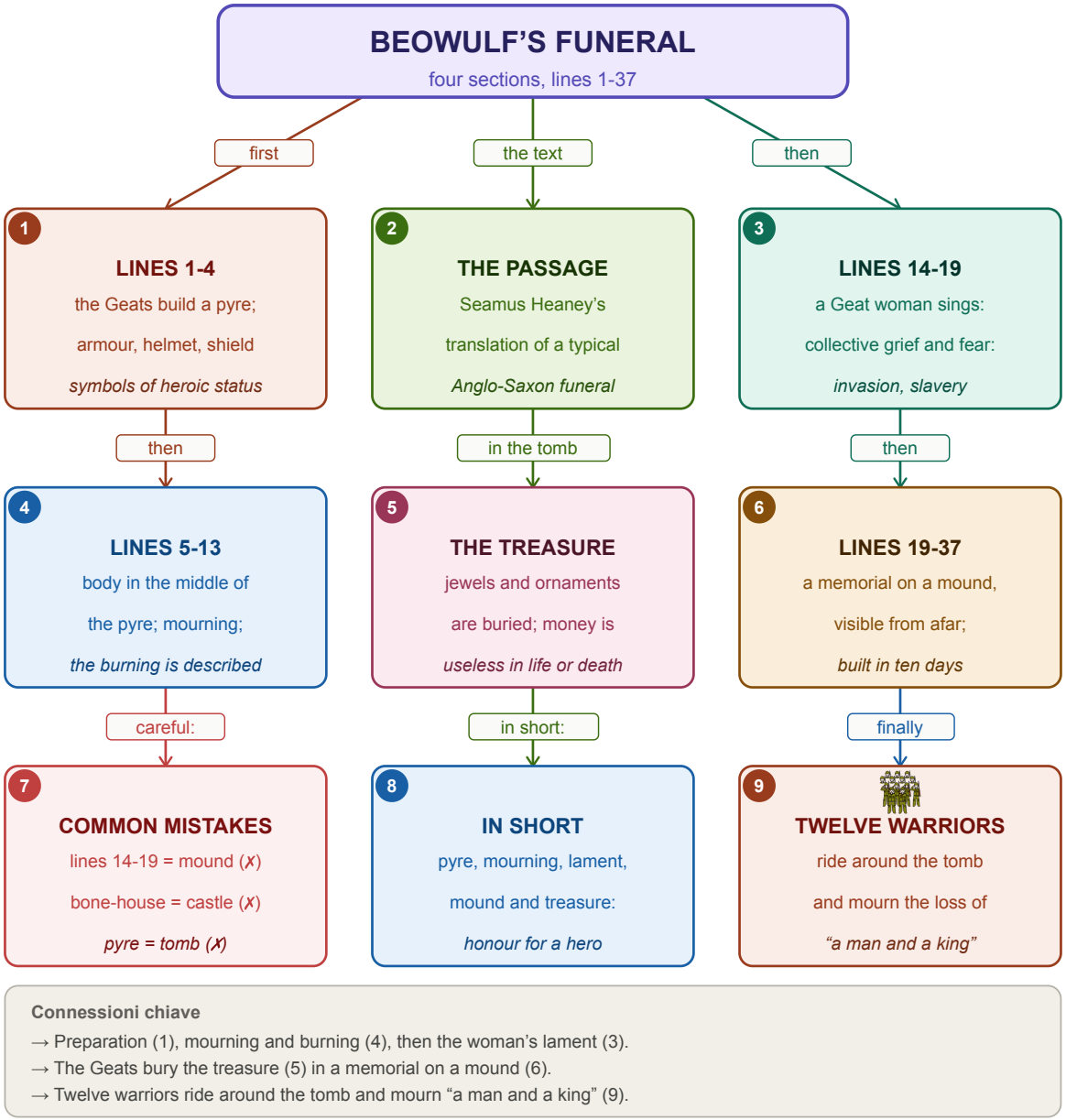
Mappa concettuale · Beowulf



Connessioni chiave

→ A legend from oral tradition (1), written down by a cultured Christian man (4).
→ Three parts: Grendel (2), 50 years as king (5), the dragon (8).
→ Beowulf is a perfect hero (3), not a flat character, and he faces death.

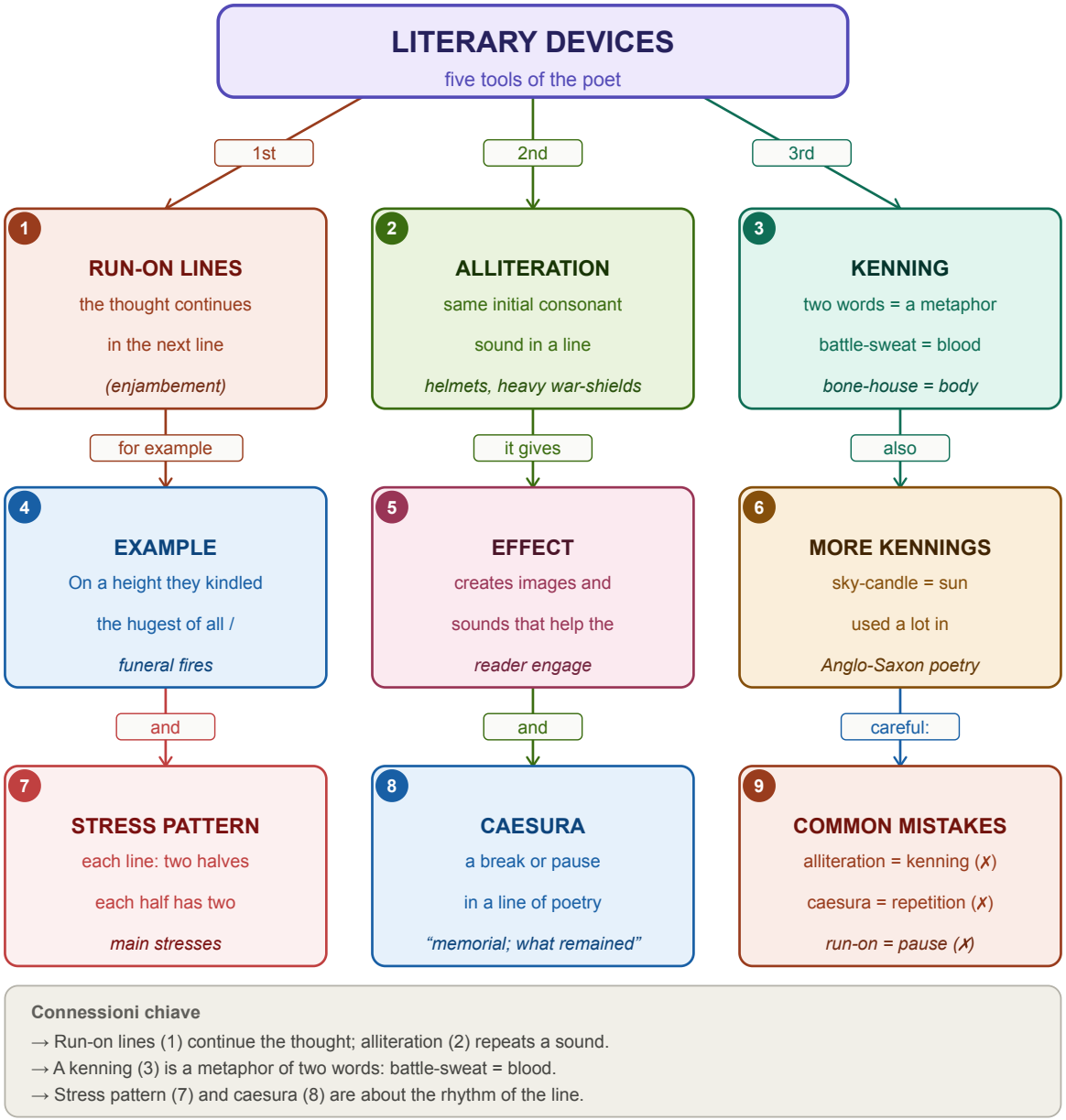
Mappa concettuale · Beowulf's Funeral



Connessioni chiave

→ Preparation (1), mourning and burning (4), then the woman's lament (3).
→ The Geats bury the treasure (5) in a memorial on a mound (6).
→ Twelve warriors ride around the tomb and mourn "a man and a king" (9).

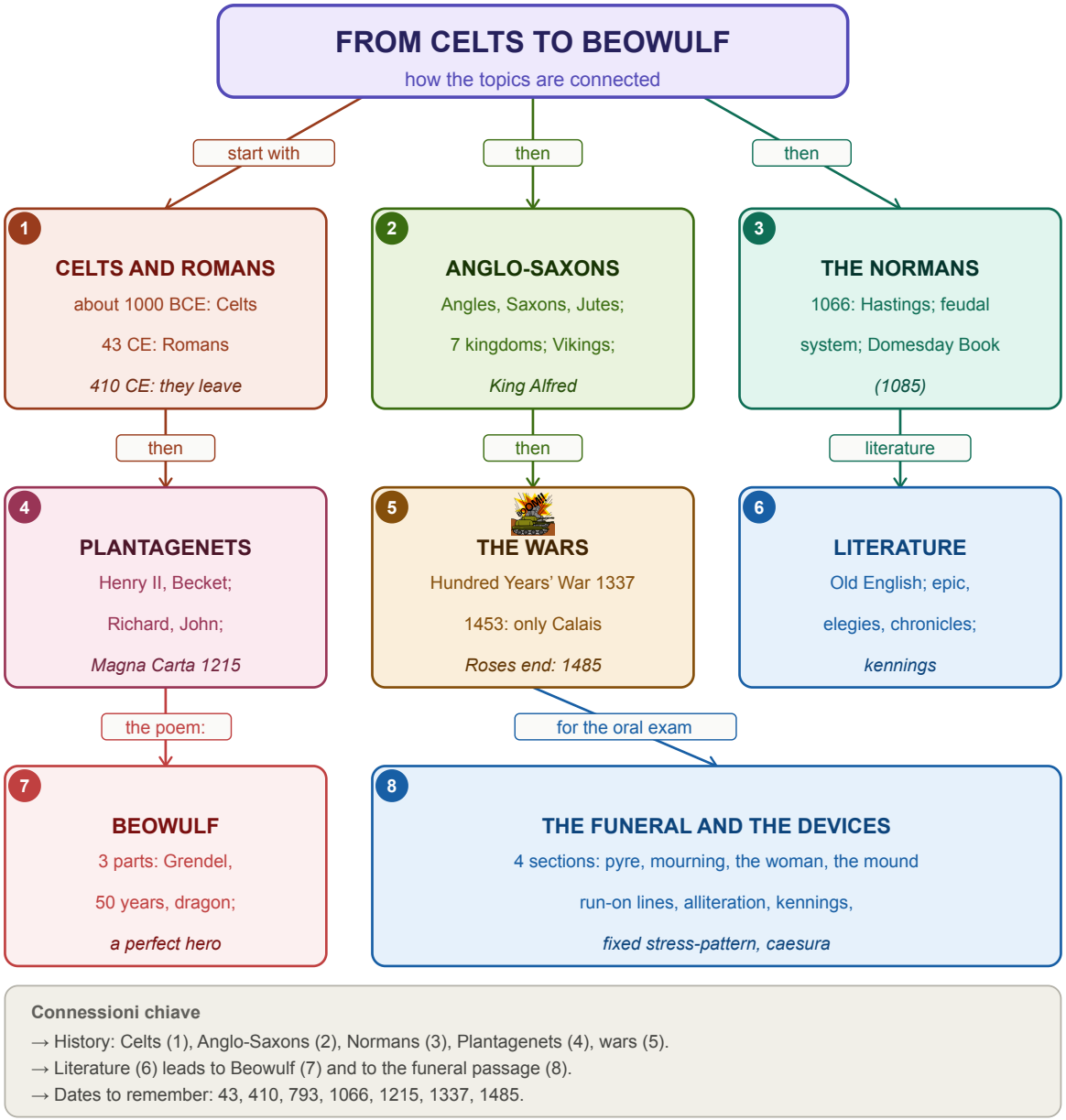
Mappa concettuale · Literary devices



Connessioni chiave

→ Run-on lines (1) continue the thought; alliteration (2) repeats a sound.
→ A kenning (3) is a metaphor of two words: battle-sweat = blood.
→ Stress pattern (7) and caesura (8) are about the rhythm of the line.

Mappa concettuale · Overview



Connessioni chiave

→ History: Celts (1), Anglo-Saxons (2), Normans (3), Plantagenets (4), wars (5).
→ Literature (6) leads to Beowulf (7) and to the funeral passage (8).
→ Dates to remember: 43, 410, 793, 1066, 1215, 1337, 1485.